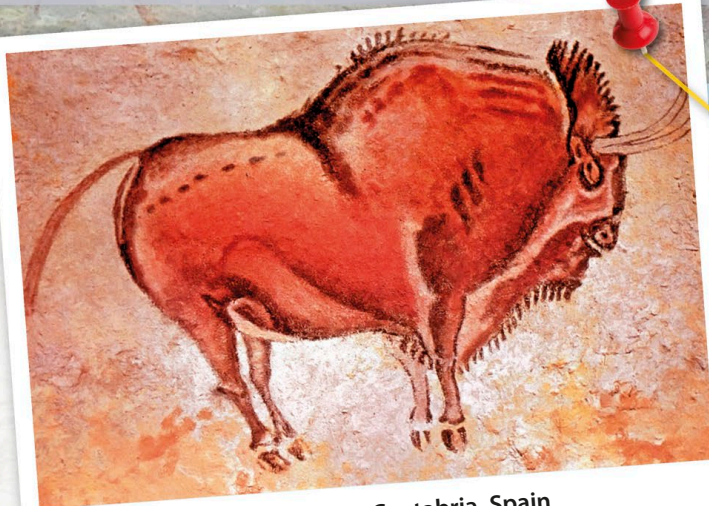


Caves of the world

Stone Age humans often made their homes in caves because they provided a ready made house and were often close to water, which would attract animals. People decorated these caves with magnificent prehistoric paintings, many showing animals. The artists may have painted to celebrate success at hunting or as a way of communicating with the spirit world.

Red buffalo

These cave paintings in Altamira Cave were the first ever found. They show animals including horses, goats, and buffalo. The paintings changed the way early people were viewed. Up until then, people did not think that early people could draw and paint.



Altamira Cave, Cantabria, Spain



Cave of Hands (Cueva de las Manos), Santa Cruz, Argentina

Cave of Hands

Early people in Argentina created these wonderful outlines of hands. They placed their hands on the wall and blew paint over the wall to create the painting. It may have been a way of leaving a signature or sign, perhaps for the spirit world.